Name: _____ Date: _____

DECLARING INDEPENDENCE

July 4, 1776
A claim in writing

Just Listen Learning • Episode 10 • Just listen, together.

1. Who or What Am I?

Write the word from the box that matches each clue.

Lexington	Concord	Washington	Paine
Lee	Jefferson	Declaration	consent

1. April 19, 1775 fighting that began open war
   _____
2. Town west of Boston where stores were sought
   _____
3. Chosen June 15, 1775 to lead the Continental Army
   _____
4. Author of the January 1776 pamphlet Common Sense
   _____
5. Virginia delegate whose resolution called for independence
   _____
6. Main writer of the Declaration draft
   _____
7. Document Congress adopted on July 4, 1776
   _____
8. Governments get just powers from the ___ of the governed
   _____

2. Poster Time!

Draw a Reading of the Declaration

Draw a town square or army camp where the Declaration is being read aloud (no fighting). Then finish the sentence.

People heard the news when: _____

3. Then and Now: True or False?

Read each sentence. Write T if it is true or F if it is false.

____ 1. Lexington and Concord happened on April 19, 1775.

____ 2. The Second Continental Congress met in New York in May 1775.

____ 3. Congress chose George Washington to command the Continental Army.

____ 4. Common Sense was written by Thomas Jefferson.

____ 5. Congress voted for independence on July 2, 1776.

____ 6. The Declaration lists complaints against the king, including quartering soldiers.

4. Think About It!

Answer in complete sentences.

1. What does consent of the governed mean in plain words?
   _____
   _____
2. Name two steps that came before July 4, 1776.
   _____
   _____

5. Timeline

Number the events 1 to 5, earliest first.

- ☐ Common Sense
- ☐ July 4 Declaration adopted
- ☐ Lexington & Concord
- ☐ Lee Resolution vote
- ☐ Washington named commander

War begins, a pamphlet spreads, a vote, then the written reasons.

Answer Key: Declaring Independence

Just Listen Learning • Episode 10 • For parents and teachers

1. Who or What Am I?

1. Lexington
2. Concord
3. Washington
4. Paine
5. Lee
6. Jefferson
7. Declaration
8. consent

2. Poster Time!

Drawings will vary. Look for a reading, a broadside/paper, a town gathering, or a camp — keep it non-graphic.

3. Then and Now: True or False?

1. T (NPS Minute Man / LOC: April 19, 1775)
2. F (Philadelphia; LOC and National Archives)
3. T (NPS / Mount Vernon / NARA: June 15, 1775)
4. F (Thomas Paine; LOC and Mount Vernon)
5. T (National Archives Lee Resolution; LOC declara timeline)
6. T (Declaration text at National Archives: quartering large bodies of armed troops)

4. Think About It!

1. A government's just powers come from the people who live under it (their agreement).
2. Any true pair: Lexington/Concord; Second Continental Congress / Washington chosen; Common Sense; Lee Resolution / July 2 vote; Jefferson draft / Committee of Five.

5. Timeline

1. Lexington & Concord (1775)
2. Washington named commander (1775)
3. Common Sense (1776)
4. Lee Resolution vote (1776)
5. July 4 Declaration adopted (1776)

Box numbers as printed, top to bottom: 3, 5, 1, 4, 2

All drawings on this worksheet are original line art. Facts come from the Just Listen episode "Declaring Independence".